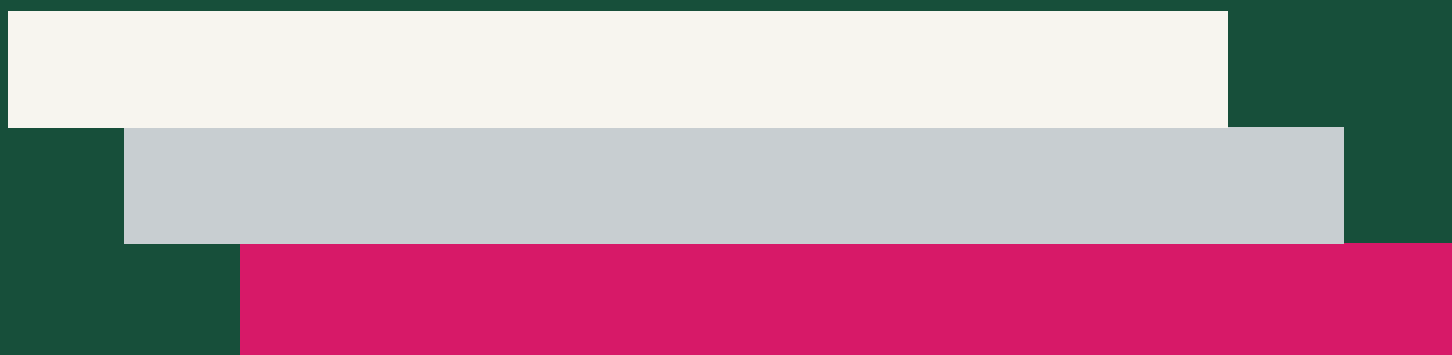


Task state is a call stack for agent work

Keep the parent task's return address when curiosity opens a tangent.



Three steps from published

- **Generate the hero.**

- **Wire the manifest.**

- **Build the route.**

- **Tangent 1:** Why does the prompt name excluded colours?

- **Tangent 2:** Is a 1.63 MB PNG normal?

Both tangents started with the human.

Either side can open a tangent



The initiator changes. The requirement does not: preserve the parent task and its next step before focus moves.

Internal todo state is not shared task memory

- **Session-bound:** it may disappear with a new chat, compaction, restart, or agent switch.
- **Human-blind:** it cannot see a tangent that starts in the human's head.
- **Context-thin:** "normalize hero" omits evidence, rejected paths, blockers, and where to resume.

The work needs state both collaborators can inspect.

The repository protocol

`.local/scratch/task-state.md` is a plain Markdown task ledger shared through the workspace.

It holds the **current focus**, item **statuses + next step**, **open threads**, and **key findings**.

1 Reconcile it with the request and working tree before editing.

2 Checkpoint it before a tangent consumes the active context.

3 Resume from the waiting item and its next step.

Why `.local`? It is gitignored while unfinished, persists with the workspace, and is not promoted into shared project policy.

Ask the workspace, not the transcript

"What are my pending items?"

1**Reconcile****2****Choose****3****Continue**

The ledger makes curiosity reversible. The full article link is in the post text.